

CHARACTERS

FIGHTERS

Fighters are humans who train for battle. It is their job to fight monsters and to protect the weaker members of a party. Great heroes such as Hercules were fighters.

The prime requisite for a fighter is Strength. Strong fighters can kill monsters more easily with their powerful blows. A Strength score of 13 or greater will give the fighter a bonus on earned experience points.

RESTRICTIONS: Fighters use eight-sided dice (d8) to determine their hit points. In addition to this advantage, they may use any weapon, wear any type of armor, and may use shields.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Though they have no special abilities like special sight or bonuses, fighters are very powerful characters. Their greater endurance (more hit points), strong armor, many weapons, and great strength make them a necessary part of every party of adventurers.

HALFLINGS

Halflings are small, good-natured demi-humans averaging only 3 feet in height and weighing about 60 pounds. They are outgoing but not unusually brave, seeking treasure as a way of gaining the comforts of home which they so dearly love.

The prime requisites for a halfling are Strength and Dexterity. A halfling character whose Strength or Dexterity score is 13 or greater will receive a 5% bonus to earned experience. Halflings whose Strength and Dexterity scores are 13 or greater will receive a bonus of 10% to earned experience.

RESTRICTIONS: Halflings use six-sided dice (d6) to determine their hit points. They may advance to a maximum of 8th level of experience. Halflings can use any type of weapon and armor which has been "cut down" to their size. Thus, they cannot use a two-handed sword or a long bow, but may use a sword or short bow. Halflings must have a minimum score of 9 in both Dexterity and Constitution.



D&D: BASIC

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Halflings have better saving throws than most other character classes. They are very accurate with all missile weapons and gain a bonus of +1, in addition to Dexterity adjustments, on their "to hit" rolls when using them (see **COMBAT**). Due to their small size and skills at dodging, halflings have a bonus of -2 on their Armor Class when being attacked by creatures larger than man-sized. When rolling for individual initiative (an Optional rule) halflings add +1, in addition to any Dexterity adjustments. Outdoors, halflings are difficult to spot, having the ability to seemingly vanish into woods or underbrush. Halflings have only a 10% chance of being detected in this type of cover, and even in dungeons there is a one-third chance (a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6) that a halfling will not be seen in normal light if the character finds some cover (such as shadows), and remains absolutely quiet and still.

MAGIC-USERS

Magic-users are humans who, through study and practice, have learned how to cast magic spells. Merlin the Magician was a famous magic-user.

The prime requisite for magic-users is Intelligence. A magic-user with an Intelligence score of 13 or greater will gain a bonus on earned experience.

RESTRICTIONS: Magic-users use four-sided dice (d4) to determine their hit points. They may not wear armor nor use shields and may only carry a dagger for a weapon.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Magic-users use many powerful spells. As they gain levels of experience, they also gain the ability to cast more and more spells. Magic-user spells are discussed in **Part 3: SPELLS** (pages B15-18). Though they are weak at first, magic-users can eventually become very powerful.

THIEVES

Thieves are humans who are trained in the arts of stealing and sneaking. They are the only characters who can open locks and find traps without using magic to do so. Due to these abilities, a thief is often found in a normal group of adventurers. As their name indicates, however, they do steal — sometimes from members of their own party.

The prime requisite of a thief is Dexterity. A thief with a Dexterity score of 13 or greater will gain a bonus on earned experience points.

RESTRICTIONS: Thieves use four-sided dice (d4) to determine their hit points. They may wear nothing more protective than leather armor, and may not use a shield. They may, however, use any type of weapon.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: When striking *unnoticed* from behind, a thief gains a bonus of +4 on "to hit" rolls and inflicts twice the normal amount of damage. A thief's training includes learning how to pick pockets, climb steep surfaces, move silently, hide in shadows, open locks (with a set of lockpicks or burglar's tools), remove small traps (such as poisoned needles), and how to hear noises better than other humans. As a thief progresses in level, he or she becomes more proficient in these "thiefly" skills. A table for determining a thief's success in each category (depending on his or her level of experience) is given on page B8.